



Puerto Rico Institute for Psychedelic Science, Medicine & Awareness  
San Juan, Puerto Rico

September 8, 2026

Dr. Caravella McCuistian  
Editor-in-Chief, *Journal of Psychoactive Drugs*  
Taylor & Francis

Dear Dr. McCuistian,

We submit our manuscript, "Ceremonial Entheogen Use in Puerto Rico: A Descriptive Survey of Participants and a Small Facilitator Subsample," for consideration as an Original Research article in the *Journal of Psychoactive Drugs*.

**What the study is.** We conducted an anonymous, bilingual, cross-sectional online survey of adults aged 21 and over who reported prior involvement in entheogen-assisted ceremonies in Puerto Rico, fielded 24 February–9 June 2026 by convenience and chain-referral sampling ( $N = 73$  analytic sample, of 100 submissions). The survey describes who participates, how ceremonies are structured, what preparation and screening practices participants and facilitators report, satisfaction with the most recent ceremony, and a safety domain covering non-consensual physical contact and facilitator-witnessed crisis signs. A small facilitator subsample ( $n = 8$ , 7 of whom are also participants) is described separately and cannot be statistically linked to the participants they served, since the instrument does not connect a participant to the specific ceremony or facilitator involved.

**Why it fits the journal's scope.** *Journal of Psychoactive Drugs* regularly publishes naturalistic, survey-based descriptions of ceremonial and community psychedelic/entheogen use outside clinical-trial settings — including closely comparable recent work such as the ayahuasca-ceremony-attender survey from Portugal published in this journal. Our manuscript extends that line of survey-based, non-clinical description to a Spanish-speaking Caribbean jurisdiction that has not previously been characterized this way.

**The novelty claim.** To the authors' knowledge, this is the first descriptive characterization of ceremonial (as opposed to solitary or clinical) entheogen use practices in Puerto Rico. One prior Puerto Rico-specific survey exists (Vélez Rodríguez et al., cited in the manuscript) but characterizes psilocybin use patterns and personality correlates without describing how ceremonies are conducted, and an unpublished thesis examined student perceptions of psilocybin mushrooms without collecting ceremonial practice or safety data. No prior study describes ceremony structure, preparation, screening, or safety outcomes for this population.

**An honest statement of the study's limits.** This is a descriptive, non-probability, unweighted survey of a self-selected sample. It supports no claim about the prevalence of ceremonial entheogen use in Puerto Rico and no causal inference about what any practice produces; its principal contribution is descriptive and instrument-level, identifying what a properly powered successor study would need to measure, sample, and correct. The manuscript states this explicitly in the abstract, Discussion, and Conclusion, and we ask that reviewers evaluate it on those terms.

**Originality and concurrent submission.** This manuscript is original, has not been published previously in whole or in part, and is not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have reviewed and approved the submitted version and agree to its submission to *Journal of Psychoactive Drugs*.

**Disclosures.** The study was approved by the Institutional Review Board of the University of Puerto Rico, Medical Sciences Campus (OPPHIE 2509472552). It received no specific grant from any funding agency in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors. Several authors are affiliated with organizations that conduct, advocate for, or provide services related to psychedelic and entheogen research and practice; the full competing-interests statement, including two authors' financial interests (ownership of Within Psychological Services; Chief Medical Officer role at Sattva Clinic), appears in the manuscript and title page.

We believe this manuscript will interest your readership and thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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